NATIVE M3 PRO

Smart and efficient RO water purifier with reassuring warranty

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Urban Company has traditionally been known as a home services platform. But its experience repairing and servicing appliances has also given it an opportunity to build products of its own. Its Native range of water purifiers is built around a problem familiar to most RO owners: frequent filter replacements, recurring service costs, and little visibility into the health of the machine. The company's new water purifier, named Native M3 Pro, is aimed at addressing these concerns. It is priced at Rs 24,999 and promises up to three years of operation without routine filter changes or servicing. It also comes with a stainless steel storage tank, a dot-matrix display, real-time water quality monitoring, and app-based diagnostics.

I have been using the Native M3 Pro to see how well it performs in everyday use, and whether its connected features make a meaningful difference.

Design and build

The Native M3 Pro looks more like a modern smart-home appliance than a conventional RO purifier. The black exterior combines matte and glossy surfaces, with a very clean front fascia. There is no large logo or cluttered control panel. I like that it only has three small touch-sensitive buttons with lit icons. More on this in the next section.

We got it mounted on the kitchen wall next to the sink. The cabinet measures 326 x 294 x 555mm and weighs around 8.5kg without water. You can also use it on a countertop. The additional external pre-filter (black in colour and cylindrical in shape) also takes up some space. Also, the black surface would require frequent cleaning.

The use of a food-grade storage tank is one of the bigger upgrades here. The tank holds around 6 litres and also houses a UV LED for keeping stored water protected. Urban Company gives the tank a separate 10-year warranty, which adds some reassurance to what is otherwise a fairly expensive appliance.

The 6-litre capacity is also one of the M3 Pro's weaknesses. At this price, I would have preferred a slightly larger tank. That volume is enough for a small family, but it can feel restrictive when you have a gathering or party at your place, and you are using the purified water for cooking also.

Overall, I find the design more appealing than the more traditional water purifiers in the market.

On-device controls and the front panel display

The M3 Pro's front panel is much cleaner yet more interesting than what you normally get on an RO purifier. There are only three touch controls for different dispensing modes, viz., Glass, Bottle, and Free-Flow. Even if you tap on the Glass or Bottle option, tapping them again stops the flow whenever you want.

There is a dot-matrix display next to these controls, which lights up when you are dispensing water and shows details such as the amount of water being dispensed, TDS, today's temperature, tank water level, and your daily water usage. I like the fact that the Native purifier is being transparent with key information like this in such a neat way. I would have liked this display more if it gave me an option to keep it on always with the aforementioned details.

Companion app and "smart home" features

The purifier works with Urban Com-